General Science

Alveary

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Science

General Science: Grade 3

GRADE(S): 3

About the Course

Students explore more complex ideas, such as ecosystems, weather and seasonal changes, water, food chains, life cycles, adaptation, and migration. Coordinating afternoon activities are provided in Outdoor Work.

This topic is included in the following course(s): Science: Grade 3

About Science: Grade 3
In level 3, learners are developing familiarity and friendship with Creation through a broader scope of Things, more challenging text, and more abstract concepts.

Science: Grade 3
The Big Picture:
To accomplish the goal of supporting a relationship with the Things of the Universe, a Mason science program consists of nature lore, natural history, and general science. Nature immersion, inquiry, community connection, and supportive literature are woven into each of these three parts. Form 1 learners in grades 1-3 are at the beginning of this relationship: developing familiarity and friendship with Creation. Their sense of community is primarily focused on their immediate environment at this stage, but they are curious about others. The familiarity with foundational knowledge grown and nurtured in Form 1 prepares them for greater curiosity and personal interest in Form 2.

Nature lore is timeless knowledge that is passed through a community, much like a grandmother passes on how to make that special bread when the dough just "feels right." Like Mason, we strive to pass on this knowledge primarily through outdoor work. Group nature walks, seasonal readings, and topics in scouting are provided as an Outdoor Work resource in the Quick Links. If desired, literature suggestions to support lore can be found in the Community Read Alouds resource (in Literature Grades 1-3).

Placement & Combining Tips

About Science: Grade 3
In level 3, learners are developing familiarity and friendship with Creation through a broader scope of Things, more challenging text, and more abstract concepts.

Scheduling

GRADE	SCHEDULE INFO.	BOOKS
3	General Science: Grade 3 1 time/week 15 min	Buzztail and Leaper Next Time You See a Cloud Going Home

Sample Weekly View

Day 1	Day 2	Day 3	Day 4	Day 5
Science: Grade 3				
General Science: Grade 3 Nature Walks & Scouting: Grades 1-8	Nature Notebook: Grade 3	Natural History: Grade 3		

Planning & Prep

Permission to print for non-commercial use. See Alveary group use policy to use lessons in a group context.

LINKS: Click text or scan the QR code in the top corner of the lesson plan pages to view online resources associated with the lessons.

Responsibility for previewing all links rests with the teacher. All links were checked at the time of publication; however, websites change frequently and may contain objectionable content. Please report broken links by contacting us through our website.

Science: Grade 3
☐ Obtain any supplies indicated on the science or grade-level supply lists.
☐ Download any apps and shortcut any desired links.

Nature Lore:
☐ Bookmark your Outdoor Work Quick Link, so that you have it available on your weekly outing. Outdoor Work is generally flexible for your location and season and can be moved around in the schedule to incorporate or substitute Natural History Club outings.
☐ Print or bookmark grade-specific nature notebook suggestions to support natural history and general science. Notebooking can be done on a walk, during occupations, or as a field trip, as appropriate.

Special Topics & Field Trips

Science: Grade 3
☐ Learn a few of your local species on these special topics using the internet, field guides, or your local nature preserve, conservancy, or state/national park.
☐ Note whether there are particular locations nearby for the student to easily notice the special topics on walks or during afternoon occupations.

General Science: Grade 3
☐ Term 1: fruits, trips in evenings, and a pet store with snakes, a herp (reptile/amphibian) conservancy, or a natural history museum; Week 11 suggests looking for snake habitat. If you are anxious about snakes, consider a program at a local nature preserve or state/national park instead.
☐ Term 2: clouds, trips in evenings, an owl/raptor conservancy/wildlife rehabilitator or natural history museum, and an aquarium/pet store/fish market at a grocery store, or a natural history museum
☐ Term 3: fish, birds, tree buds, trips to a pond, and a natural history museum

Term Prep & Teacher Tips

Science: Grade 3
Object lesson prompts are woven into the lessons, as appropriate, but teachers are encouraged to read corresponding Handbook of Nature Study (HoNS) selections each term:

General Science: Grade 3
☐ Term 1: snakes p.193-203, ladybugs p.364-366
☐ Term 2: clouds/water forms p.808-814, screech owls p.100-103
☐ Term 3: migrating birds p.35-38, bird beaks p.39-40, and/or choose 1-2 local birds from p.50-143

☐ Gather household items, typically easy for students to scavenge or teachers to obtain locally:
• means to make a small collection (small box or selection of boxes, photo album, etc)

Reminders

General Science: Grade 3
☐ Students will raise ladybugs at the start of Term 1, so make a note in your calendar to order them at the appropriate time and be flexible with the schedule to accommodate their development and release according to the instructions that come with them.

Books & Resources

For book rationales and purchase options, click the Book List link or scan the QR code below.

∞ [View Book List Details]

General Science: Grade 3

Buzztail and Leaper

Next Time You See a Cloud

Going Home

Supplies

For supply list details and basic supplies helpful to have on hand, click the links or scan the QR code below.

∞ View Basic Supplies

∞ View Supply List Details

General Science: Grade 3

Household Items - General Science: Grade 3

Ladybug Land with Voucher to Obtain Larva

Large Owl Pellet Kit

Small Collection Containers

Quick Links

(No Quick Links Assigned)

Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.

General Science: Grade 3

How To Teach

Introduce

• Begin each lesson with learners' existing knowledge. If the book or activity is new or unfamiliar, then look at the title, a picture, or guidance in the lesson plan to help discuss what students think, drawing on previous experience. If continuing or revisiting a topic or activity, then recap. The lesson plans often help with this.

• Some learners may benefit from using pictures or looking back briefly.

• Allow them time to share any concerns and come alongside, as needed.

Complete

• Read, or do, as instructed in the lessons, noting any Teacher Tips provided. Learners should always have their nature journal or some other notebook/paper available in case they need to draw or diagram during the lesson.

• When reading to pre-readers, point to the words as you read, even if it seems like they aren't paying attention.

• If learners do not understand a word or concept, do not worry. Try to show them with a picture or connect the idea to something they have seen in real life. They are learning much by the way and will likely build understanding over the term, the year, or beyond.

Narrate

• Process the ideas of the lesson by retelling the events in sequence, describing a scene or setting, explaining a concept, etc.

• Learners may use words, pictures, Legos, dolls, etc., to process and convey ideas in the manner most natural to them.

• Teachers may take turns to model.

Discuss

• Consider together any thoughts, confusion, or concerns about the passage.

• Questions/topics for further discussion are often provided in the lesson plans to help. There are no right or wrong answers to these. If teachers want to keep ideas active in the mind, these can also be used at other times to keep the ideas in the working memory.

Connect

• Follow any extra links, examine any sidebars in the text, look at pictures, etc., depending on learner interest.

• These can also be viewed as alternative ways to engage.

General Science: Grade 3

[Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.]

Term 1

WEEK 1

⬚ 15m General Science: Grade 3 - Lesson 1

Noticing Clouds

Materials: Next Time You See a Cloud

PREP: Read Teacher Tip

→ INTRO
Look at the picture on the cover. Have you watched clouds before? What do you think it would feel like to touch a cloud?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS
p.7-18 "Next time you" - "about to change."

• We call the living Things the biome. The living and non-living parts of the environment together are called the ecosystem. Water is one of those non-living parts of the ecosystem. Can you think of some ways that water affects the living Things?

★ TEACHER TIP
Let students enjoy the photographs in this picture book and take time to talk about them.

★ TEACHER NOTE
If you haven't ordered your larvae yet - don't forget!

● NATURE NOTEBOOK
Prompt for General Science in Outdoor Work Quick Link.

WEEK 2

⬚ 15m General Science: Grade 3 - Lesson 2

Observing Ladybug Larvae Activity

Materials: Nature Journal, Ladybug larvae

PREP: Read Teacher Tip

→ INTRO
Spend about 10 minutes observing your ladybug larvae in their habitat today and plan to check on them every day to watch them change. What parts are you able to notice? Are there visible body segments? Are there legs? If so, how many? Are there eyes? Antennae? What are the larvae doing?

→ OBSERVE

→ NARRATE & DISCUSS
Use a nature journal to record what the student noticed.

• A habitat must provide the food, water, and shelter that a living Thing needs, but it is very different from a real ecosystem. How does your habitat provide what the ladybug larvae need? How is it different from the ladybug's natural ecosystem?

★ TEACHER TIP
If students seem anxious or unsure about their nature journal, teachers can encourage them by modeling, showing them many different examples, journaling in tandem, or by serving as a scribe.

★ TEACHER TIP
Raising ladybugs provides many opportunities for object lessons on several stages of the insect's life over the next two weeks or so. Questions are embedded in the lesson to help, as needed. If preferred, teachers can instead refer to the Handbook of Nature Study or allow questions to flow naturally between student and teacher.

WEEK 3

⬚ 15m General Science: Grade 3 - Lesson 3

Observing Larvae or Pupae Activity

Materials: Nature Journal, Ladybug larvae

PREP: Read Teacher Tip

→ INTRO
Spend about 10 minutes observing your larvae or pupae today and plan to check on them every day to watch them change. What do you notice today?

→ OBSERVE

★ TEACHER TIP
The time that it takes for the ladybugs to emerge will vary slightly, so enjoy them while you have them and release them based on the instructions that came with them.

Term 1

→ NARRATE & DISCUSS
Use a nature journal to record what the student noticed.

WEEK 4

⬚ 15m General Science: Grade 3 - Lesson 4

Observing Ladybugs and Watching the Clouds Go By Activity

Materials: Nature Journal, Ladybugs, if not yet released

→ INTRO
Spend about 10 minutes observing your ladybugs today, if you have not yet released them. What parts are you able to notice on the adult beetle? How does it differ from the larva? What colors and markings do you notice? How does it use its wings? If you have released them already (or as you watch them fly away), notice the clouds in the sky or their absence if it is a clear day. What colors and shapes do you notice in the sky? Are the clouds moving or changing? Do you think they are cirrus, stratus, or cumulus? Or maybe some combination?

→ OBSERVE

→ NARRATE & DISCUSS
Use a nature journal to record what the student noticed.

- Tell about what you recorded.

- NATURE NOTEBOOK Prompt for General Science in Outdoor Work Quick Link.

WEEK 5

⬚ 15m General Science: Grade 3 - Lesson 5

Noticing Clouds

Materials: Next Time You See a Cloud

→ INTRO
What kinds of clouds have you noticed since we last read? Let's read some more about clouds today.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS
p.19-29 "As more and more" - "that remarkable?"

- Where does the rain that condenses from the clouds go? Find a major river on your globe that is near the student's home/school and trace its path to the ocean. If you were a drop of water in that river, what kinds of plants and animals might you pass on your way? What if one of them drank you? If you made it the whole way to the ocean, then what?
- Diagram the water cycle showing how that water droplet gets back up into the clouds.

- NATURE NOTEBOOK Prompt for General Science in Outdoor Work Quick Link.

WEEK 6

⬚ 15m General Science: Grade 3 - Lesson 6

Observing Clouds Activity

Materials: Nature Journal

→ INTRO
Spend about 10 minutes observing clouds. What colors and shapes do you notice in the sky? Are the clouds moving or changing? Do you think they are cirrus, stratus, or cumulus? Or maybe some combination? Does their appearance change from one part of the sky to another?

→ OBSERVE

→ NARRATE & DISCUSS

- NATURE NOTEBOOK Prompt for General Science in Outdoor Work Quick Link.

Term 1

Use a nature journal to record what the student noticed.

● Tell about what you recorded.

WEEK 7

⬚ 15m General Science: Grade 3 - Lesson 7

Caterpillars and Pupae Activity

Materials: Nature Journal

→ INTRO
Spend about 10 minutes looking at and/or observing caterpillars and pupae. Some good places to look might be underneath the leaves of plants, around the base of plants, and on twigs or branches. If you find one, notice its colors and patterns, size, and any nearby plants. Collect as many clues as you can about who this might be.

→ OBSERVE

→ NARRATE & DISCUSS
Use a nature journal to record what the student noticed.

● What are some ways that you could find out who this is?

WEEK 8

⬚ 15m General Science: Grade 3 - Lesson 8

A Creature in Context

Materials: Buzztail and Leaper

→ INTRO
This is two books in one, so we are going to start with Buzztail. Have you ever come across a snake before when playing or on a walk? If so, tell about it. What did you think of the snake?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS
p.3-13 "The rattlesnake" - "would come along."

● Talk about a food chain based on what you read. You might diagram, if desired. Do you have these same animals or similar ones in your biome? What other animals would be in yours? Do you know which of these creatures are cold-blooded and which are warm-blooded? When it's too cold for cold-blooded creatures, how does that affect the food chain?

★ TEACHER NOTE
Page 13 doesn't actually have the page number, so you may need to indicate it before the reading.

WEEK 9

⬚ 15m General Science: Grade 3 - Lesson 9

Buzztail's Adaptations

Materials: Buzztail and Leaper

→ INTRO
Where did we leave Buzztail in the last passage? Let's find out something more about him today.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS
p.14-24 "Every so often" - "female snake again."

● Diagram the snake, discussing the special adaptations described in the story. Adaptations are special behaviors or body parts that fit a creature to its purpose in the ecosystem.

● NATURE NOTEBOOK
Prompt for General Science in Outdoor Work Quick Link.

General Science: Grade 3

[Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.]

Term 1

WEEK 10

⬚ 15m General Science: Grade 3 - Lesson 10

Buzztail's Habitat

Materials: Buzztail and Leaper

→ INTRO
Recall what you heard about Buzztail in the last passage.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS
p.25-35 "Something else" - "to attack him."

• What have you heard so far about the snake's habitat? Does he live in just one? Who else lives in this biome with the snake?

• NATURE NOTEBOOK
Prompt for General Science in Outdoor Work Quick Link.

WEEK 11

⬚ 15m General Science: Grade 3 - Lesson 11

Observing Habitat Activity

Materials: Nature Journal

PREP: Read Teacher Tip

→ INTRO
Spend about 10 minutes observing the habitats near you. Are there any that would be good homes for snakes? (You are thinking about the habitat, not necessarily searching for snakes.) Remember to always use a stick to help if you want to look under something, so that your fingers don't surprise a hidden creature. If you want to lift up a rock or log, always lift the side that is away from you. If you come across a snake, keep your distance and don't corner it unless you are sure it is safe. Describe the habitat. What other living Things live there?

→ OBSERVE

→ NARRATE & DISCUSS
Use a nature journal to record what the student noticed.

• Tell about what you recorded.

★ TEACHER TIP
This could be a good opportunity for an object lesson with a snake, if the student comes across one that is dormant or dead. Be sure to notice if the snake is responding to changes in the weather or season.

WEEK 12

⬚ 15m General Science: Grade 3 - Lesson 12

Exam Week

→ EXAMS
Answer question(s) related to course.

Questions will come from:
Next Time You See a Cloud, Buzztail and Leaper, Nature Journal

• NATURE NOTEBOOK
Prompt for General Science in Outdoor Work Quick Link.

General Science: Grade 3

[Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.]

Term 2

WEEK 1

⬚ 15m General Science: Grade 3 - Lesson 13

Observing Seasonal Changes Activity

Materials: Nature Journal

PREP: Read Teacher Tip

→ INTRO
Spend about 10 minutes observing two easy-to-see signs of the season: clouds and birds. What colors and shapes do you notice in the sky? What colors and patterns do you see in the birds? Are the clouds moving or changing? Do you think they are cirrus, stratus, or cumulus? How do the birds behave? Do you know these birds? What colors or markings do you notice? Do the clouds and birds seem different today than they did last term?

→ OBSERVE

→ NARRATE & DISCUSS
Use a nature journal to record what the student noticed.

- Tell about what you recorded.

★ TEACHER TIP
There is no implied connection between clouds and birds; they are simply Things that can signal seasonal change. If teachers would like to do an object lesson on birds or clouds, this could be a good day. Questions are embedded in the lesson to help, as needed. If preferred, teachers can instead refer to the Handbook of Nature Study or allow questions to flow naturally between student and teacher.

WEEK 2

⬚ 15m General Science: Grade 3 - Lesson 14

How Buzztail Spends the Season

Materials: Buzztail and Leaper

PREP: Read Teacher Tip

→ INTRO
Do you recall where we left Buzztail?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS
p.36-45 "Buzztail struck" - "force something out."

- Can you tell what time of year it is in the story? Why is the snake basking in the sun? What do you think the female rattlesnake is going to 'force out'?

★ TEACHER TIP
It has been several weeks since students left Buzztail, so they may need some help recalling where the story left off. It is okay to look back at the pictures on previous pages or even read the last few sentences from p.35, if they need this help.

WEEK 3

⬚ 15m General Science: Grade 3 - Lesson 15

Life Cycle of a Snake

Materials: Buzztail and Leaper, Nature Journal

→ INTRO
What did Buzztail see on his journey? Are you ready to find out what happens to the female rattlesnake?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS
p.46-55 "At last a" - "swollen and discolored."

→ DIAGRAM
Begin to diagram the life cycle of the rattlesnake (you will continue over the next few weeks). Compare its lifecycle to that of an insect and a bird. Many reptiles, insects, and birds are oviparous - they are egg (ovo-) producing (parous). Mammals, like cats, skunks, and bats, are viviparous - they are live (vivi-) producing (parous). Some creatures are ovoviviparous - they are a little of both.

- NATURE NOTEBOOK
Prompt for General Science in Outdoor Work Quick Link.

General Science: Grade 3

Term 2

WEEK 4

⬚ 15m General Science: Grade 3 - Lesson 16

Life Cycle of a Snake

Materials: Buzztail and Leaper

PREP: Read Teacher Tip

→ INTRO
What happened in the last passage? What do you think is going to happen next? Let's finish Buzztail's story today. The author uses the word 'hibernation' to describe what happens to the snakes over winter, but snakes don't actually hibernate like mammals because they are cold-blooded. Cold-blooded snakes brumate (i.e. become extremely slow) rather than sleep.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS
p.56-64 "Quickly he" - "whatever came along."

→ DIAGRAM
Continue your lifecycle diagram, adding important parts of Buzztail's ecosystem at each stage of his lifecycle. You could show other plants and animals, special body adaptations, water, season, and/or habitat - whatever seems important to you. If you don't have enough time to finish this week, you can continue this next week.

★ TEACHER TIP
If students need help understanding the difference between hibernation and brumation, it can help to imagine brumation like the change that happens when syrup is cold versus warm, whereas hibernation is more like a deep sleep.

★ TEACHER TIP
Note the safety tip at the bottom of p.57.

WEEK 5

⬚ 15m General Science: Grade 3 - Lesson 17

Illustrating a Snake's Life Activity

Materials: Nature Journal, Buzztail and Leaper

PREP: Read Teacher Tip

→ INTRO
Recall what we know about Buzztail's lifecycle.

→ ACTIVITY
Spend about 10 minutes finishing your lifecycle diagram.

→ NARRATE & DISCUSS
- Explain what you recorded.

★ TEACHER TIP
If students finished this activity last week, have them draw a picture or comic showing the difference between hibernation and brumation. Alternatively, they can act out a scene with puppets or dolls.

WEEK 6

⬚ 15m General Science: Grade 3 - Lesson 18

Observing Seasonal Changes Activity

Materials: Nature Journal

→ INTRO
Spend about 10 minutes observing two easy-to-see signs of the season: clouds and birds. What colors and shapes do you notice in the sky? What colors and patterns do you see in the birds? Are the clouds moving or changing? Do you think they are cirrus, stratus, or cumulus? How do the birds behave? Do you know these birds? Do the clouds and birds seem different today than they did last term?

→ OBSERVE

→ NARRATE & DISCUSS
Use a nature journal to record what the student noticed.

- Tell about what you recorded.

• NATURE NOTEBOOK
Prompt for General Science in Outdoor Work Quick Link.

General Science: Grade 3

[Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.]

Term 2

WEEK 7

⬚ 15m General Science: Grade 3 - Lesson 19

Dissecting an Owl Pellet Activity

Materials: Nature Journal, owl pellet dissection kit

PREP: Read Teacher Tip

→ INTRO
Scientists learn about creatures, like Buzztail, by studying their habitats, their food, and by doing experiments. For example, we can learn a lot about an owl and its habitat by finding out what it's eating. After an owl eats, it regurgitates a pellet that contains all of the undigestible parts of its prey. What kinds of things do you think might be in an owl pellet? Let's find out by dissecting one!

→ ACTIVITY
Spend about 10 minutes dissecting an owl pellet. If you need a bone chart, there is one at the link. You will not finish this activity today, so take your time.
∞ Image Link: All About Owl Pellets

→ NARRATE & DISCUSS
Use a nature journal to record what the student noticed.

• Tell about what you found or what you recorded.

★ TEACHER TIP
Students have 2 lessons scheduled to spend on their owl pellet dissection. If there is significant interest, provide additional time in the afternoon.

• NATURE NOTEBOOK
Prompt for General Science in Outdoor Work Quick Link.

WEEK 8

⬚ 15m General Science: Grade 3 - Lesson 20

Dissecting an Owl Pellet Activity

Materials: Nature Journal, owl pellet dissection kit

→ ACTIVITY
Spend about 10 minutes dissecting an owl pellet. If you don't finish today, you can come back to it during an afternoon. If you need a bone chart, you can find one at the link.
∞ Image Link: All About Owl Pellets

→ NARRATE & DISCUSS
Use a nature journal to record what the student noticed.

• Tell about what you found or what you recorded.

• NATURE NOTEBOOK
Prompt for General Science in Outdoor Work Quick Link.

WEEK 9

⬚ 15m General Science: Grade 3 - Lesson 21

Leaper in Context

Materials: Buzztail and Leaper

→ INTRO
Today, we begin the story of Leaper. Look at the picture on the cover. What sort of creature is Leaper? Have you ever seen a live fish before?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS
p.66-75 "It was late" - "three inches long."

• Leaper's egg hatches in a freshwater biome. What other plants and animals live in his biome? What do you know so far about the non-living parts of the ecosystem that affect Leaper?

• NATURE NOTEBOOK
Prompt for General Science in Outdoor Work Quick Link.

General Science: Grade 3

[Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.]

Term 2

WEEK 10

⬚ **15m General Science: Grade 3 - Lesson 22**

Leaper in the Food Chain

▯ Materials: Buzztail and Leaper

→ INTRO
Tell me what happened to Leaper in the last passage. Today, we'll hear a bit more about Leaper's life and the other creatures that live with him.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS
p.77-87 "One afternoon" - "shut behind him."

• What do you know so far about the food chain here? Where is Leaper on the food chain? Draw or diagram, if helpful.

• NATURE NOTEBOOK
Prompt for General Science in Outdoor Work Quick Link.

WEEK 11

⬚ **15m General Science: Grade 3 - Lesson 23**

Leaper's Ecosystems

▯ Materials: Buzztail and Leaper

→ INTRO
Recall what you heard about Leaper in the last passage. Leaper is getting ready for a big change, so let's find out about that!

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS
p.88-95 "A few miles" - "to the east."

• Leaper is moving from the freshwater biome into the marine biome. What do you notice about how the living and non-living parts of the ecosystem are changing around him?

WEEK 12

⬚ **15m General Science: Grade 3 - Lesson 24**

Exam Week

→ EXAMS
Answer question(s) related to course.

Questions will come from:
Buzztail and Leaper, Nature Journal

General Science: Grade 3

[Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.]

Term 3

WEEK 1

⬚ 15m General Science: Grade 3 - Lesson 25

Observing Seasonal Changes Activity

Materials: Nature Journal

PREP: Read Teacher Tip

→ INTRO
Spend about 10 minutes observing two easy-to-see signs of the season: clouds and birds. What colors and shapes do you notice in the sky? What colors and patterns do you see in the birds? Are the clouds moving or changing? Do you think they are cirrus, stratus, or cumulus? How do the birds behave? Do you know these birds? What colors and markings do you notice? Do the clouds and birds seem different today than they did last term?

→ OBSERVE

→ NARRATE & DISCUSS
Use a nature journal to record what the student noticed.

● Tell about what you recorded.

★ TEACHER TIP
There is no implied connection between clouds and birds; they are simply easy-to-notice indicators of seasonal change. If teachers prefer to do an object lesson on birds today, this could be a good day. Questions are embedded in the lesson to help, as needed. If preferred, teachers can instead refer to the Handbook of Nature Study or allow questions to flow naturally between student and teacher.

● NATURE NOTEBOOK
Prompt for General Science in Outdoor Work Quick Link.

WEEK 2

⬚ 15m General Science: Grade 3 - Lesson 26

Leaper in the Food Chain

Materials: Buzztail and Leaper

PREP: Read Teacher Tip

→ INTRO
Do you recall where we left Leaper?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS
p.96-105 "When spring came" - "He was caught."

● How has Leaper's food chain changed at this stage in his life? What are the reasons that Leaper's food chain changes?

★ TEACHER TIP
It has been several weeks since students left Leaper, so they may need some help recalling where the story left off. It is okay to look back at the pictures on previous pages or even read the last few sentences from p.94, if they need this help.

★ TEACHER NOTE
Page 105 doesn't actually have the page number, so you may need to indicate it before the reading.

WEEK 3

⬚ 15m General Science: Grade 3 - Lesson 27

Leaper Moves

Materials: Buzztail and Leaper

→ INTRO
What happened to Leaper in the last part of the story? What do you think is going to happen next?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS
p.106-115 "Leaper thrashed" - "pushed on upstream."

● Did you notice the changes that humans made that helped Leaper on his migration? What were they? How did they help?

General Science: Grade 3

[Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.]

Term 3

WEEK 4

⬚ 15m General Science: Grade 3 - Lesson 28

Life Cycle of a Fish

Materials: Buzztail and Leaper

→ INTRO
Remind me what happened to Leaper last time. Do you think he will finish the journey? It seems like a hard journey. Why is he going all this way?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS
p.116-128 "On they went" - "another time."

● How do different parts of the ecosystem affect Leaper's life cycle? This could include the land, seasonal changes, special features in his body, other plants and animals, etc. Draw or diagram, if helpful.

WEEK 5

⬚ 15m General Science: Grade 3 - Lesson 29

Observing Trees Activity

Materials: Nature Journal

→ INTRO
Spend about 10 minutes comparing the buds of two trees. If they have already bloomed, then compare the young growth at the ends of their twigs.

→ OBSERVE

→ NARRATE & DISCUSS
Use a nature journal to record what the student noticed.

WEEK 6

⬚ 15m General Science: Grade 3 - Lesson 30

Observing Seasonal Changes Activity

Materials: Nature Journal

PREP: Read Teacher Tip

→ INTRO
Spend about 10 minutes observing two easy-to-see signs of the season: clouds and birds. What colors and shapes do you notice in the sky? What colors and patterns do you see in the birds? Are the clouds moving or changing? Do you think they are cirrus, stratus, or cumulus? How do the birds behave? Do you know these birds? Do the clouds and birds seem different today than they did last term?

→ OBSERVE

→ NARRATE & DISCUSS
Use a nature journal to record what the student noticed.

● Tell about what you recorded.

★ TEACHER TIP
This could be a good opportunity for an object lesson with birds or clouds.

● NATURE NOTEBOOK
Prompt for General Science in Outdoor Work Quick Link.

WEEK 7

⬚ 15m General Science: Grade 3 - Lesson 31

Lots of Animals Move!

Materials: Going Home

→ INTRO
What was Leaper's migration like? Do you know about how far or how long the

● NATURE NOTEBOOK
Prompt for General Science in Outdoor Work Quick Link.

Term 3

migration was? Do you know of any other creatures that migrate? This book is about the annual migrations that many animals make each year. One of our migrating animals is on the cover. Do you know who he is? Do you know any other migrating friends that you might find in our book?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS
Going Home

● Imagine yourself as one of the animals in the book. What would it take to travel on such a long journey? What obstacles might you face? How would you find your way?

WEEK 8

⬚ 15m General Science: Grade 3 - Lesson 32

Mapping the Arctic Migration

> Materials: Going Home, globe

→ INTRO
Tell me about some of the creatures that we read about last time. Today, we'll follow some of the journeys on our globe.

→ ACTIVITY
Going Home
Notice the map toward the end of the book and find this view on your globe. Find where you are on the globe (teacher's help, as needed). Using the time you have, choose an animal, reread their poem, and trace their migration on the globe.

→ DISCUSS
Which trip was surprising to you? Most interesting? Who do you think had the longest journey?

● NATURE NOTEBOOK
Prompt for General Science in Outdoor Work Quick Link.

WEEK 9

⬚ 15m General Science: Grade 3 - Lesson 33

Museum Curator Activity

> Materials: Nature Journal, found nature items, collecting containers or other means of collecting

PREP: Read Teacher Tip

→ INTRO
Over the next few weeks, you will curate your own ecosystem museum. Your museum may contain as many or as few Things as you want to represent your ecosystem. Your museum can be in whatever form(s) you like and is most appropriate for the Things you want to represent. It could be a collection of samples, photographs, drawings, or any combination of those. An example is shown at the link. Spend about 10 minutes today deciding what ecosystem you want to tell about through your museum. Looking through your nature journal and any collected nature items will help.
∞ Image Link: Museum Example

→ ACTIVITY

→ NARRATE & DISCUSS
Share what was decided, what ideas the student has, and whether any help is needed.

★ TEACHER TIP
If there is significant interest, provide additional time in the afternoons.

● NATURE NOTEBOOK
Prompt for General Science in Outdoor Work Quick Link.

General Science: Grade 3

[Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.]

Term 3

WEEK 10

⬚ **15m General Science: Grade 3 - Lesson 34**

Museum Curator Activity

Materials: Nature Journal, found nature items, collecting containers or other means of collecting

→ ACTIVITY
Continue working on your museum by collecting additional Things or organizing those already collected.

→ NARRATE & DISCUSS
Share what was completed, what ideas the student has, and whether any help is needed.

WEEK 11

⬚ **15m General Science: Grade 3 - Lesson 35**

Museum Curator Activity

Materials: Nature Journal, found nature items, collecting containers or other means of collecting

→ ACTIVITY
Finish your museum by organizing and arranging the last of your Things.

→ NARRATE & DISCUSS
Now you are the docent! Tell about your ecosystem museum.

WEEK 12

⬚ **15m General Science: Grade 3 - Lesson 36**

Exam Week

→ EXAMS
Answer question(s) related to course.

Questions will come from:
Going Home, Buzztail and Leaper, Nature Journal

General Science: Grade 3

Examination

Term 1

- Tell about or diagram the ways that water affects the living things in the ecosystem.

Term 2

- Tell about or diagram to explain a life cycle or food chain.

Term 3

- Tell about or draw reasons that animals migrate.